CTC Hackathon 2026

TriStar

Triangle Smart Targeting and Real-Time Activation

Combined Hackathon Proposal

Combining Morning Star + Triangle Offer Design Copilot

Category: **Omni Channel Growth**

Impact Area: **Triangle Program Growth & Incremental 1:1 Offers**

Cornerstone: **Customer Centric Growth**

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Why These Two Ideas Belong Together

Both ideas sit in the same category (Omni Channel Growth), target the same program (Triangle), and are driven by the same root cause: Triangle's current model is reactive, generic, and siloed.

Morning Star diagnoses it from the customer experience side — customers aren't being reached at the right moment with the right context. The Offer Copilot diagnoses it from the marketer's side — marketers don't have intelligent tools to design the right offers in the first place. They are two sides of the same coin.

The shared insight: **personalized, timely, outcome-driven Triangle engagement is broken at both ends of the pipeline — design and delivery.**

Morning Star alone risks becoming a great delivery mechanism with poor-quality offers — it can push the right notification at the right moment, but if the underlying offer is broad and generic, the customer experience still falls flat.

The Offer Copilot alone risks becoming a smarter design tool that still feeds offers into the same disconnected, untimed channels.

Combined, they form a coherent, end-to-end loop: intelligent offer design → intelligent offer delivery.

Problem Statement

The Triangle loyalty program operates in a fragmented state that limits its ability to drive meaningful, measurable Omni channel growth:

On the Marketer Side

Offers are designed manually using spreadsheets and ad-hoc rules. Promotions are broad-based rather than tied to specific customer segments, life stages, or behavioral signals. It is difficult to know which members should receive which offer, on which channel, or what outcome to expect — making rapid experimentation nearly impossible. Measurement of long-term impact remains opaque.

On the Customer Side

Triangle members experience a reactive program that only acknowledges them after a purchase. Offers are not shaped by real-world context — location, time of day, recent activity, seasonal behavior, or upcoming needs. High-intent micro-moments (a commute, a morning coffee run, a seasonal purchase decision) pass without any intelligent nudge. The partner

ecosystem — Canadian Tire, Tim Hortons, Sport Chek, and others — operates in silos, preventing any seamless cross-brand journey.

The net result: Triangle has the data and the partner breadth to be an industry-leading proactive engagement platform, but it functions today as a basic points ledger.

Business Proposition: TriStar

TriStar is an AI-powered, two-layer platform that closes the loop between intelligent offer design and real-time offer delivery for Triangle members.

Layer 1 — The Marketer Copilot (Design Intelligence)

Marketers interact with a prompt-driven UI to describe a business objective. The copilot ingests mock Triangle member profiles and historical offer performance data and responds with:

- Recommended segment definitions (e.g., “lapsed high-value outdoor enthusiasts”)
- Offer constructs — points multipliers, threshold offers, cross-category bundles
- Suggested primary channels — email, app, in-store, push
- Estimated impact ranges — expected uplift in visit rate, basket size, or cross-category penetration
- Risk flags — over-discounting, offer cannibalization, frequency caps

The output is an exportable offer brief including segment definition, channels, creative requirements, and KPIs.

Layer 2 — The Real-Time Activation Engine (Delivery Intelligence)

Once an offer is designed and approved, the activation engine takes over. It monitors contextual signals and determines the optimal moment to deliver the offer to each targeted member:

- Location proximity to partner stores
- Time of day, day of week, and seasonal patterns
- Weather conditions and environmental triggers
- Recent purchase behavior and browsing activity
- Partner ecosystem cross-brand opportunity windows

A member near a Tim Hortons on a cold morning who hasn’t visited Canadian Tire in two weeks might receive a push notification bridging both brands. A member opening the app midweek gets a contextually timed cross-category nudge relevant to their last purchase pattern.

Together: the right offer reaches the right person at the right moment — designed with intelligence, delivered with precision.

Hackathon Build Plan

Given a one-week timeline, the prototype delivers four concrete components:

Component	Description
Marketer Copilot	A working prompt-driven interface where a marketer types a campaign objective and receives AI-generated segment definitions, offer construct recommendations, estimated uplift, and risk flags. Powered by an LLM against mock Triangle data. Exportable as a structured offer brief.
Activation Simulation	A simulated member-facing experience showing how a designed offer gets delivered in real time — with contextual triggers (location, time, weather) mapped to specific notification moments. Visual walkthrough or lightweight interactive prototype.
Unified Dashboard	A single view connecting both layers — designed offers, targeted segments, active delivery triggers, and simulated performance metrics — demonstrating the end-to-end loop.
Mock Triangle Data	Synthetic member profiles and historical offer performance data powering both layers of the demo.

Benefits and Business Case

For Marketers

Dramatically reduces the time to design and launch targeted offers. Enables rapid experimentation with AI-generated hypotheses. Replaces spreadsheet-driven guesswork with outcome-oriented, data-backed offer design.

For Customers

Triangle becomes proactive rather than passive. Members receive offers that feel relevant to their moment, not generic promotions. Cross-partner journeys feel connected and intentional.

For the Triangle Program

Higher offer redemption rates driven by relevance and timing. Increased cross-category and cross-partner engagement. Better measurement of offer impact on long-term customer value. A foundation for scaling 1:1 personalization at program scale.

For Canadian Tire as a Business

Incremental revenue from reactivated lapsed members, higher basket sizes from cross-category offers, and stronger app engagement — all tied to measurable outcomes from day one of campaign design.

Hackathon Submission Answers

Ready-to-use responses for the hackathon intake form:

What Problem are you trying to solve?

Triangle's engagement model is fundamentally reactive and fragmented — it rewards customers after a purchase but misses the chance to influence behavior before or during decision-making moments. Offers are designed manually through spreadsheets and ad-hoc rules, resulting in broad, generic promotions that aren't tailored to individual member context like location, time of day, weather, or recent activity. Channels operate in silos — in-store, online, and app experiences aren't connected through Triangle — causing high-intent micro-moments (a morning coffee run, a seasonal purchase decision) to pass without any intelligent nudge. Marketers lack the tools to rapidly experiment with targeted offers, and there is no unified way to measure offer impact on long-term Omni channel customer value.

What is your Solution (Hackathon Idea)?

TriStar is an AI-powered platform with two integrated layers that close the loop between offer design and real-time delivery. Layer 1 is a Marketer Copilot — a prompt-driven interface where marketers describe a business objective (e.g., "reactivate lapsed high-value members" or "grow cross-shop between Automotive and Outdoor") and receive AI-generated segment definitions, offer constructs (points multipliers, threshold offers, cross-category bundles), estimated uplift, channel recommendations, and risk flags like over-discounting or cannibalization. Layer 2 is a Real-Time Activation Engine that takes approved offers and delivers them to the right member at the optimal moment based on contextual signals — location, weather, time of day, partner proximity, and recent behavior. Together, TriStar transforms Triangle from a static points ledger into a proactive, context-aware engagement platform.

What Benefits will your solution bring to the customer?

For marketers, TriStar dramatically reduces the time to design and launch targeted offers — replacing spreadsheet guesswork with AI-backed, outcome-oriented recommendations and enabling rapid experimentation. For customers, Triangle becomes proactive: members receive offers that feel relevant to their moment and context, with cross-partner journeys (e.g., Tim Hortons to Canadian Tire) that feel connected rather than random. For the business, the impact is measurable from day one — higher offer redemption rates driven by relevance and timing,

increased cross-category and cross-partner engagement, reactivation of lapsed high-value members, and a scalable foundation for true 1:1 personalization across the Triangle ecosystem.